

From: motherofpekes@icloud.com
Subject: Request for Guidance: Bit Position in Relation to Cheekpiece Adjustment
Date: 16 May 2026 at 7:20 am
To: goran.akerstrom@fei.org
Cc: ronan.murphy@fei.org, caterina.termine@fei.org



Dear FEI Veterinary and Dressage Departments,

I am writing to request clarification regarding FEI guidance on the vertical positioning of the bit within the horse's mouth, specifically in relation to cheekpiece adjustment.

While FEI rules and guidelines provide detailed direction on noseband fit, blood in the mouth, and general tack compliance, I have been unable to identify any explicit guidance on what constitutes correct or acceptable bit height (e.g. degree of lip tension or visible wrinkling at the commissures).

Given the increasing body of research documenting oral lesions at the lip commissures, bars, and buccal mucosa in sport horses, I would be grateful if you could clarify:

- Whether the FEI provides any formal or recommended standard for bit position or cheekpiece adjustment
- Whether visible tension or wrinkling of the lips at rest is considered acceptable within FEI competition
- Whether stewards or veterinarians are trained to assess bit height as part of tack or welfare inspections
- How current FEI guidance on bit use aligns with emerging evidence on rein tension and oral tissue injury

If no formal guidance currently exists, could you advise whether this is an area under review within FEI welfare or veterinary committees?

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Kind regards,

Paula Lasersohn

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